

Dewald Laubscher

Senior Software Engineer | Platform Modernization | Data Infrastructure | AI-Assisted Productivity

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Professional Summary

Senior software engineer and technical leader with 12+ years of experience building full-stack, platform, and data-intensive systems across startups, through acquisitions, and enterprise environments. Recent Intuit Mailchimp experience focused on platform infrastructure, legacy modernization, large-scale data processing, microservice migrations, developer productivity, and AI-assisted engineering workflows. Strong background in pragmatic architecture, distributed systems, DDD, dependency injection, modular design, production readiness & support, and technical mentorship.

Technical Highlights

- Intuit Mailchimp platform experience across large-scale data processing—petabytes of data, customer-facing product feature sets, and shared engineering systems.
- Modernized legacy systems using Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, microservices, and Strangler Fig migration patterns.
- Improved microservice migration backfill performance by reducing processed-ID lookup complexity from $O(n)$ to $O(1)$ with a hashing-based strategy.
- Worked on systems processing petabytes of data, including SMS and Mailchimp audience data.
- Built AI-assisted orchestration workflows and collaborated on multi-agent prototypes for developer productivity, planning, and workflow automation.
- Designed AI-assisted thematic analysis workflows combining sentiment scoring, classification logic, and expert-system rules to identify themes across customer feedback.

Experience

Intuit Mailchimp

Senior Software Engineer | Aug 2022 - Present

Mississauga, Ontario / Atlanta, GA

- Contributed to platform infrastructure and legacy modernization across large-scale data systems using Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, microservices, and Strangler Fig migration patterns working in Colo and Cloud environments..
- Improved microservice migration backfill performance by designing a hashing-based lookup strategy that reduced processed-ID checks from $O(n)$ to $O(1)$.
- Worked on platform systems supporting large-scale data processing, customer-facing product capabilities, and shared engineering needs across Mailchimp and Intuit environments.
- Participated in architectural discussions around dependency injection, modular systems, domain-driven design, maintainable platform design, and roadmap-aligned technical tradeoffs.
- Built custom AI orchestration workflows and collaborated on multi-agent prototypes to improve developer productivity, planning clarity, task visibility, and workflow automation.
- Mentored engineers through complex technical work, emphasizing autonomy, clarity, maintainability, code review, and strong engineering judgment.

Software Engineer | Jun 2020 - Aug 2022 (Mailchimp Contractor)

Gauteng, South Africa

- Built and maintained full-stack software systems in a product engineering environment overseeing the technical implementation of a function by leading 5 engineers during Mailchimp's growth and acquisition by Intuit.
- Contributed to scalable, maintainable application architecture while adapting to increasing organizational, product, and technical complexity.
- Delivered reliable user-facing and internal capabilities in collaboration with product and engineering stakeholders.
- Developed pragmatic engineering judgment around patterns, roadmap alignment, maintainability, and systems that serve business outcomes.

BigTeam

Founding Engineering Lead | Oct 2019 - Jun 2020

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Provided technical direction for a small engineering team of 3-4, giving guidance through architecture decisions, code review, delivery planning, technical standards, and product execution.
- Translated ambiguous product and business needs into executable engineering plans, balancing speed, maintainability, scalability, and business impact in a fast paced startup environment.
- Helped scale the engineering function toward acquisition by Mailchimp while balancing hands-on full-stack development, technical leadership, and stakeholder alignment.
- Established lightweight engineering practices around autonomy, ownership, pragmatic architecture, maintainable systems, and delivery accountability.

Founding Engineer | Aug 2017 - Oct 2019

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Built core product systems and full-stack capabilities across front-end, back-end, and product workflows in a fast-moving startup environment.
- Designed custom AI-assisted thematic analysis workflows combining sentiment scoring, classification logic, and expert-system rules to identify recurring themes across customer feedback.
- Contributed to maintainable software architecture and technical decision-making as the product and engineering organization grew toward acquisition by Mailchimp.

Earlier Experience

Developer / Full-stack Web Developer | Sep 2014 - Sep 2019

- Delivered 80+ websites and full-stack web projects across agency, product, and client environments, building strong foundations in front-end, back-end, deployment, client communication, and production support.
- Bachelors in Computer Science and Information Technology, from NWU, Potchefstroom, South Africa (2011 - 2013)

Technical Skills

Platform Systems: Platform modernization, legacy migration, microservices, Strangler Fig, modular architecture, shared engineering systems, monolithic systems, colo to cloud migrations.

Distributed Data: Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, custom backfills, data pipelines, large-scale data processing, petabyte-scale audience data, resilience, redundancy, observability.

Architecture: Domain Driven Design, Model View Controller & OOP, dependency injection, design patterns, maintainable system design, architectural tradeoffs, scalable application architecture

AI & Productivity: AI orchestration workflows, multi-agent prototypes, workflow automation, AI-assisted planning, developer productivity, thematic analysis, sentiment scoring

Engineering: Full-stack development, API design, system design, code review, production support, distributed systems

Stack: PHP, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, Python, Kotlin, Bash, React, Angular, Vue, Node, Laravel, Spring, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Splunk, PagerDuty